

by small, round, black fruits. Suitable for a rock garden or peat bed. Needs partial shade. May also be propagated by division in spring. Z5–9

V. parvifolium illus. p.163.

V. vitis-idaea (Cowberry). Vigorous, evergreen, prostrate shrub, spreading by underground runners. H 10in (25cm), S indefinite. Forms hummocks of ovate, hard, leathery leaves. Bell-shaped, white to pink flowers are borne in nodding racemes from early summer to fall. Flowers are followed by bright red fruits in fall–winter. May also be propagated by division in spring. Z3–8. **‘Minus’** see *V.v-i.* subsp. **minus**. **subsp. minus** (syn. *V.v-i.* **‘Minus’**) illus. p.351.

VALERIANA

Valerian

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals, often rhizomatous or tap-rooted herbaceous perennials, semievergreen subshrubs, and usually evergreen shrubs, suitable for growing in borders and rock gardens. Fully hardy. Requires a position in sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by division in fall, but *V. officinalis* is best propagated by seed in spring.

V. officinalis (Cat’s valerian, Common valerian) illus. p.231.

V. phu ‘Aurea’ illus. p.262.

VALLEA

ELAEOCARPACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs or trees, grown for their habit, foliage and flowers. Frost hardy, but best kept at a minimum of 37–41°F (3–5°C) to prevent foliage being damaged by cold. Prefers a position in full sun and humus-rich, well-drained soil. In cold areas, grow in a cool greenhouse; in warmer areas, use in a courtyard garden or border, or grow against a warm sunny wall. Water containerized plants freely during the growing season, moderately at other times. Untidy growth may be cut out in early spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. Red spider mite may be a nuisance.

V. stipularis. Evergreen, erect, then loose and spreading shrub. H and S 10–15ft (3–5m). Leaves are lance-shaped to rounded and lobed, deep green above, gray beneath. Small, cup-shaped flowers, each with 5 deep pink petals that have 3 lobes, are borne in small, terminal and lateral clusters in spring–summer. Z9–11

VALLISNERIA

HYDROCHARITACEAE

Genus of evergreen, perennial, submerged water plants, grown for their foliage. Suitable for pools and aquariums. Frost tender. Requires sun or partial shade and deep, clear water. Remove fading foliage, and thin overcrowded plants as necessary. Propagate by division in spring–summer.

V. americana, syn. *V. gigantea*. Vigorous, evergreen, perennial, submerged water plant. S indefinite. Quickly grows to form colonies of long, strap-shaped, mid-green leaves. Bears insignificant, greenish flowers all year-round. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

V. gigantea. See *V. americana*.

V. spiralis (Eel grass, Tape grass) Vigorous, evergreen, perennial, submerged water plant. S indefinite. Forms a mass of long, strap-shaped, mid-green leaves, but on a smaller scale than *V. americana*. Insignificant, greenish flowers are borne year-round. Z10–11 (min. 41°F/5°C)

Vallota speciosa. See *Cyrtanthus elatus*.

VANCOUVERIA

BERBERIDACEAE

Genus of perennials, some of which are evergreen, suitable for groundcover. Fully hardy. Prefers cool, partially shaded positions and moist, peaty soil. Propagate by division in spring.

V. chrysantha. Evergreen, sprawling perennial. H to 1ft (30cm), S to 2ft (60cm). Ovate, dark green leaves borne on the flower stems are divided into rounded diamond-shaped leaflets with thickened, undulating margins. Loose sprays of small, bell-shaped, yellow flowers are produced in spring. Z7–9

V. hexandra. Vigorous, spreading perennial. H and S to 16in (40cm). Leathery leaves are divided into almost hexagonal leaflets. Produces open sprays of many tiny, white flowers in late spring and early summer. Provides good woodland groundcover. Z5–7

VANDA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.

V. Rothschildiana gx (illus. p.466). Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool or intermediate greenhouse. H 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Sprays of dark-veined, violet-blue flowers, 4in (10cm) across, are borne twice a year in varying seasons. Has narrowly ovate, rigid leaves, 4–5in (10–12cm) long. Grow in a hanging basket and provide good light in summer. Z11–12 (min. 61°F/16°C; max. 86°F/30°C)

VELLOZIA

VELLOZIACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials, grown for their showy flowers. Frost tender. Grow in full sun and moderately fertile, sharply drained soil. Propagate by seed or division in spring.

V. elegans, syn. *Barbacenia elegans*, *Talbotia elegans*. Evergreen, mat-forming perennial with slightly woody stems. H 6–8in (15–20cm), S 8in (20cm). Lance-shaped, leathery, dark green leaves, to 8in (20cm) long, have a V-shaped keel. In late spring, bears solitary, small, star-shaped, white flowers on slender stems above leaves. Z12 (min. 61°F/16°C)

VELTHEIMIA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering bulbs with dense spikes of pendent, tubular flowers and rosettes of basal leaves. Frost tender. Needs good light, to keep foliage compact and to develop flower colors fully. Requires well-drained soil. Plant in fall with bulb tips just above soil surface.

Water moderately in growth and reduce watering in summer. Propagate by seed or by offsets in fall.

V. bracteata, syn. *V. undulata*, *V. viridifolia*, illus. p.414.

V. undulata. See *V. bracteata*.

V. viridifolia. See *V. bracteata*.

x **Venidioarctotis**. See *Arctotis*.

VERATRUM

MELANTHIACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of perennials, with poisonous black rhizomes, grown for their striking, erect panicles of flowers. Fully to frost hardy. Requires partial shade and fertile, moist soil. Ideal for a woodland or wild garden. Propagate by division in fall or early spring, or by seed as soon as ripe. ☹All parts are highly toxic if ingested. Contact with foliage may irritate the skin.

V. album (White false hellebore). Clump-forming perennial. H 6ft (2m), S 2ft (60cm). Basal leaves are pleated, ovate and dark green. Stems bear dense, terminal panicles of saucer-shaped, yellowish-white flowers in summer. Z3–7.

‘Lorna’s Green’ produces pendent panicles of green flowers.

V. californicum. Upright, rhizomatous perennial. H to 8ft (2.5m), S to 2ft (60cm). Has ovate, pleated basal leaves, hairless above and curly-hairy beneath. In summer, bears branched, stiffly erect panicles of star-shaped, creamy white and green flowers, with each petal deep green at the base and veined green. Z4–8

V. nigrum (Black false hellebore) illus. p.216.

VERBASCUM

Mullein

SCROPHULARIACEAE

Genus of mainly summer-flowering biennials, with a few annuals, perennials, and subshrubs, some of which are semi-evergreen or evergreen. Grown mainly for their tall stems of flowers borne over a long period. Fully to frost hardy. Tolerates shade, but prefers an open, sunny site and well-drained soil. Propagate species by seed in spring or late summer, or by root cuttings in winter; selected forms by root cuttings only. Some species self-seed freely.

V. bombyciferum, syn. *V. broussa*. Evergreen, erect biennial. H 5–6ft (1.5–2m), S to 2ft (60cm). Ovate leaves and stems are covered with silver hairs. Produces upright racemes densely set with 5-lobed, yellow flowers in summer. Z4–10

V. broussa. See *V. bombyciferum*.

V. ‘Caribbean Crush’. Upright, rosette-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 5ft (1.5m). Has ovate-oblong, toothed, woolly, gray-green leaves. From late spring to summer, bears saucer-shaped flowers in tones of apricot, yellow, pink, and copper-orange, all on the same plant. Z5–8

V. chaixii. Erect perennial, covered with silvery hairs. H to 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has ovate, toothed, rough, nettlelike leaves. Produces slender spires of 5-lobed, yellow, sometimes white flowers, with purple stamens, in summer. Z5–8

V. ‘Christo’s Yellow Lightning’. Vigorous, upright, rosette-forming

perennial. H 5ft (1.5m) or more, S 2ft (60cm). Has broadly lance-shaped, wavy-edged, gray-green leaves. In summer, bears saucer-shaped, pale yellow flowers. Z5–8

V. ‘Cotswold Beauty’ illus. p.246.

V. ‘Cotswold Queen’. Short-lived, rosette-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1ft (30cm). Throughout summer, bears saucer-shaped, yellow flowers on stems that arise from ovate, mid-green leaves. Z5–8

V. dumulosum illus. p.345.

V. ‘Gainsborough’ illus. p.243.

V. ‘Letitia’ illus. p.343.

V. lychnitis (White mullein). Slow-growing, evergreen, upright, branching biennial. H 2–3ft (60–90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has lance-shaped, dark gray-green leaves. Flattish, 5-lobed, white flowers are borne on branching stems in summer. Z5–9

V. nigrum. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Bears narrow spikes of small, 5-lobed, purple-centered, yellow flowers during summer and fall. Oblong, mid-green leaves are downy beneath. Z4–8

V. olympicum illus. p.219.

V. ‘Pink Domino’. Short-lived, rosette-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1ft (30cm). Produces branched racemes of 5-lobed, rose-pink flowers throughout summer, above ovate, mid-green leaves. Z5–11

VERBENA

VERBENACEAE

Genus of summer- and fall-flowering annuals, perennials, and subshrubs. Fully hardy to frost tender. Prefers sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by stem cuttings in late summer or fall, or by seed in fall or spring.

V. bonariensis, syn. *V. patagonica*, illus. p.221.

V. chamaedrifolia. See *Glandularia peruviana*.

V. chamaedrioides. See *Glandularia peruviana*.

V. x hortensis. See *Glandularia x hybrida*.

V. x hybrida. See *Glandularia x hybrida*.

V. patagonica. See *V. bonariensis*.

V. rigida, syn. *V. venosa*, illus. p.269.

V. ‘Sissinghurst’. See *Glandularia ‘Sissinghurst’*.

V. venosa. See *V. rigida*.

VERONICA

PLANTAGINACEAE/SCHROPHULARIACEAE

Genus of annuals, perennials, and mostly deciduous subshrubs, grown for their purple, blue, pink or white flowers. Fully to frost hardy. Some need sun and well-drained soil, others prefer a moist site in sun or partial shade. Grow taller species in a mixed or herbaceous border; cushion- or mat-forming species are ideal for a rock garden. Propagate by division in spring or fall, by softwood or semiripe cuttings in summer, or by seed in fall.

V. austriaca. Mat-forming or upright perennial. H and S 10–20in (25–50cm). Leaves are very variable: from broadly ovate to narrowly oblong, and from entire to deeply cut and fernlike. Short, dense or lax racemes of small, saucer-shaped, bright blue flowers are produced in early summer. Suits a rock garden or bank. Z3–8.